

Maurice Sievan at Vanderwoude Tananbaum Gallery



Eebak, 1962, oil on canvas, 86"x69"

A rare group of late paintings by Maurice Sievan is on view at the Vanderwoude Tananbaum Gallery, 24 East 81 Street, April 1-26. Maurice Sievan (1898-1981) was an acquaintance of Mark Rothko, Milton Avery, and other leading artists of the 1950's. During his lifetime, his work was shown in major museums throughout the United States, South America, and Paris, including the Museum of Modern Art, Metropolitan Museum of Art, Corcoran, and Salon D'Autome.

Thin washes of paint, agitated brushstrokes, and insubstantial and fleeting forms distinguish these paintings which Dore Ashton called "full romantic statements" when they were first shown in 1961. She wrote:

"A mature painter who came late to abstract means, Maurice Sievan . . . proved that his journey was well worth the time it took.

He offers large, resonant abstractions that in their dark harmonies are full, romantic statements. He is an able painter and has built up mirror-like surfaces of great beauty. Within the darkling depths of his compositions, Sievan suggests looming shapes, but they are never more than suggested. Waves and crests and shadows and thighs and buttocks melt together in his images toward an elemental whole."

—Dore Ashton, *Art International*, 1961